MKTG3112 Marketing Communications · Individual Essay

Alo in Australia: Reflection and Alternative Approach

Student number: [ ]

Word count: Question One 652; Question Two 1055 (headings and body text; excluding figures, notes, prompts, references and appendices). Total 1,707

Question One: Evaluating “Mat to Moment”

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not generating reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Judged against its four objectives, Mat to Moment is likely to lift store awareness (O3) but is least likely to achieve perceived worth (O1), the objective the group ranked first (Appendix A).

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A remains the right audience. Its members treat activewear as part of their identity (Belk, 1988), Pilates is among Australia’s fastest-growing activities (Australian Sports Commission, 2025), and the segment is reachable on Instagram and TikTok (Kemp, 2026). However, the report identified a tension it did not resolve. The women most drawn to Alo are also the most financially stretched (Deloitte, 2026). At A$100–200 per item, Alo is “masstige” rather than luxury, and new-luxury buyers trade up in only a few categories while trading down elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). The group applied Kapferer and Bastien’s (2009) rule that luxury needs meaning rather than justification, but a stretched buyer needs exactly that justification, because guilt suppresses indulgent purchases unless the context supplies a reason (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

“From Mat to Moment” is clear and single-minded, and its calm after-class moments are divergent in a category that shows sweat (Smith & Yang, 2004). Its weakness is distinctiveness. Athleisure is defined as clothing for both exercise and everyday wear (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and the report itself notes that P.E Nation sells “studio-to-street” leggings (P.E Nation, n.d.). The proposition therefore describes the category, which puts the 60% brand-attribution threshold at risk. The price argument is also weak in mass media. On reach channels, Worth it is a peripheral “instructor-tested”

cue (Petty et al., 1983), a quality claim that never addresses price. The central route operates only for people who visit a product page, a store or one of 36 sessions, which reach hundreds. Because peripheral attitudes are weaker and fade faster (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986), O1 rests on the narrowest part of the plan.

1.4 Channel Selection

Seven touchpoints suit the budget. However, outdoor takes A$55,000 (22%), the largest single line, despite its low audience selectivity for a narrow segment (Belch & Belch, 2021). Only 43% of the budget buys paid reach, leaving little margin for Burst 1's 70% reach target. Concentration can deliver more. Ben & Jerry's 2025 Snapchat campaign reached more than 3 million Australians and lifted ad awareness by 13 points (Snap Inc., 2025).

1.5 Integration

Integration is the plan's main strength. The line, set and sign-off stay fixed across every touchpoint, while only the hook and call to action adapt (Batra & Keller, 2016). There is, however, a structural inconsistency. The objectives follow Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do order, yet the journey and bursts follow AIDA, placing Attention first and the rational Worth it proof at Desire in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). The price argument therefore reaches only those who progress that far. About 42% of spend also sits in high-impact, low-control activities (Duncan, as cited in Belch & Belch, 2021), with one lead creator as a single point of failure.

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

O3 is likely, because one simple fact repeated near the stores suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983). O2 is plausible through local sources (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 is at risk, and O4 depends on it, because behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980). Measurement is honest but partial. Platform holdouts give causal evidence only for paid social, 21% of spend (Gordon et al., 2019), while outdoor, sessions and PR are judged on before-and-after change. With about 400 respondents, only five-point changes are reliable, so the six-point attitude targets sit near the detection limit.

1.7 Recommended Improvements

Three changes would raise effectiveness: confront price openly and at scale rather than through events, replace the category proposition with an ownable one, and move budget from outdoor and sessions into measurable social media. Question Two develops these into an alternative.

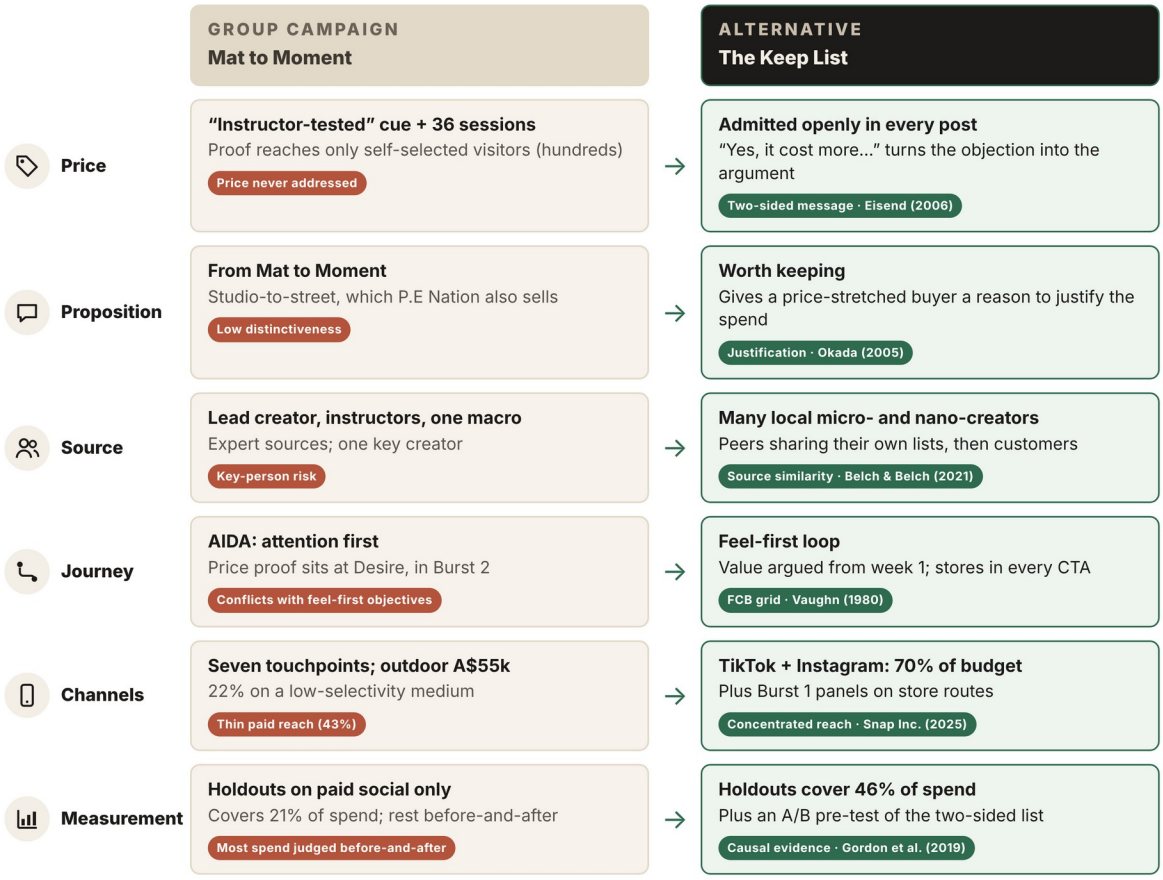
Question Two: An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

2.1 What Changes and Why

The Keep List retains Segment A, objectives O1–O4 and the A$250,000 budget, but changes the message, persuasion route, sources, journey and media mix. Each change answers a weakness from Question One (Figure 1). O1 becomes the lead objective.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses from Question One; tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

Segment A is retained because its fit with Alo still holds (Belk, 1988; Inside Retail, 2026). What changes is the insight. Financial pressure makes young consumers delay major decisions (Deloitte,

2026), but they do not cut back quietly. In 2024, “loud budgeting”, openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of choice rather than lack (Axios, 2024). Segment A is cutting back out loud, and what they keep says who they are. The campaign’s job is to make Alo something they keep.

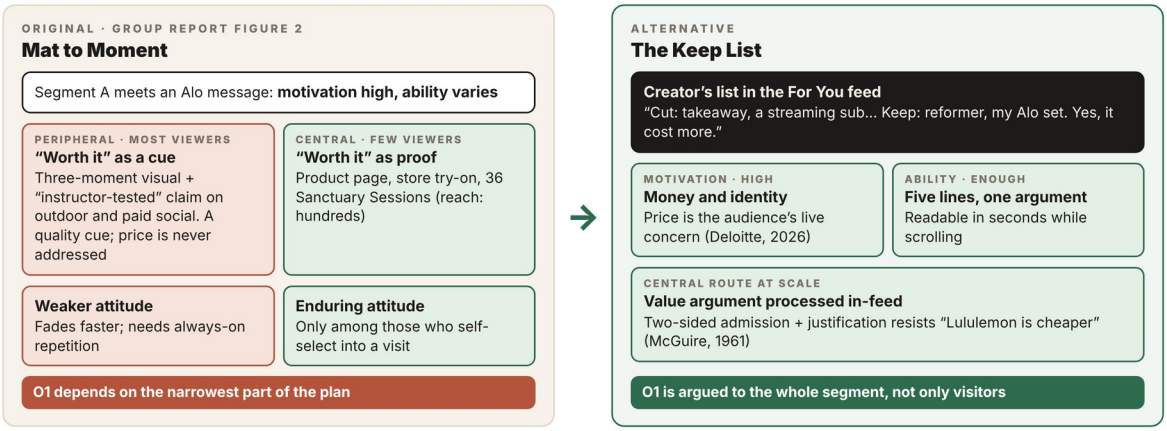
2.3 Message and Persuasion Route

The original message was one-sided. The Keep List is two-sided: creators admit that Alo costs more, then explain why it is worth keeping. Peers, not Alo, discuss price, protecting prestige (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009). Two-sided messages increase source credibility (Eisend, 2006), and refuting an objection in advance protects against counter-arguments (McGuire, 1961) such as “Lululemon is cheaper”. The list also supplies the missing justification (Okada, 2005). Under mental accounting, consumers assign spending to separate budgets (Thaler, 1999), so setting Alo beside cancelled takeaway moves it from “fashion splurge” to “things I use every day” (Appendix B). It stays a rational value appeal without discounts, which raise price sensitivity (Belch & Belch, 2021; Mela et al., 1997).

Figure 2 shows the change. Originally, central processing of price required a visit. A five-line list is read in seconds yet carries one argument, so motivated viewers can process it centrally while scrolling (Petty et al., 1983). O1 is therefore argued to the whole segment, not only to visitors.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report’s Figure 2.

2.4 Sources

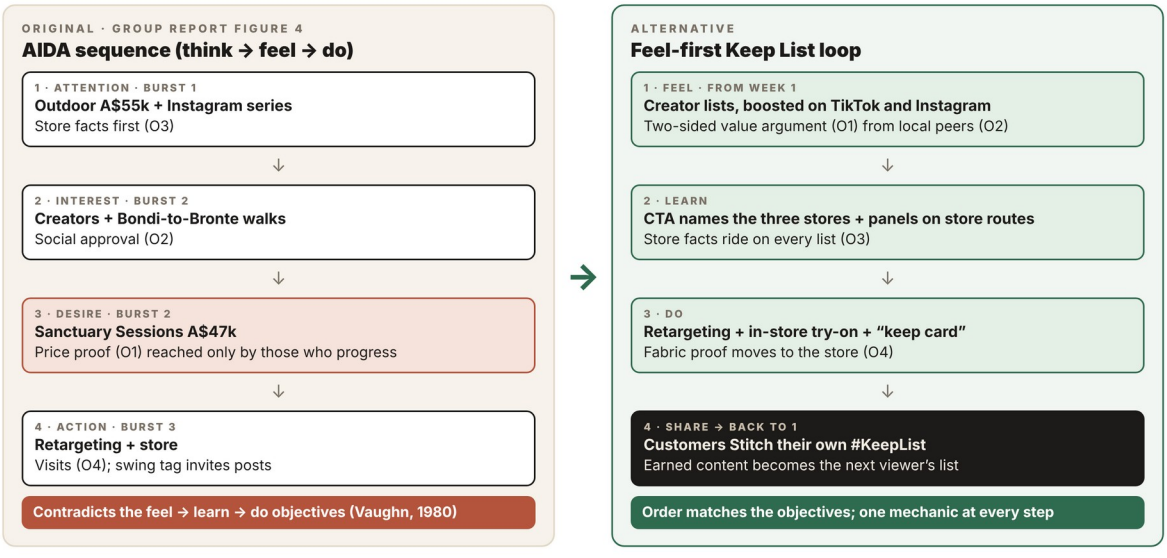
The lead and macro creators are replaced by many Sydney micro- and nano-creators, then customers. Smaller creators achieve higher engagement and closer trust (Campbell & Farrell, 2020), and similarity to the audience is part of source attractiveness (Belch & Belch, 2021). Spreading the brief also removes the single point of failure. frank green's customer-made TikTok content shows the model working (TikTok for Business, n.d.). "Keep List" is an ownable mechanic rather than a category benefit, so it should be easier to attribute to Alo (Sharp, 2010).

2.5 Journey, Channels and Budget

Figure 3 replaces the AIDA sequence with a feel-first loop that matches Vaughn's (1980) order. Lists build attitude (O1, O2), every call to action names the stores (O3), retargeting and in-store try-ons drive visits (O4), and customers' Stitches feed the next viewer (Court et al., 2009). Creator posts are boosted as paid ads, so paid, owned and earned media carry the same content (Stephen & Galak, 2012). Staff hand buyers a "keep card", and Burst 3 posters show consented customer lists, so one mechanic runs through every touchpoint. Pulsing is retained, with Burst 1 now led by lists (Appendix C).

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After

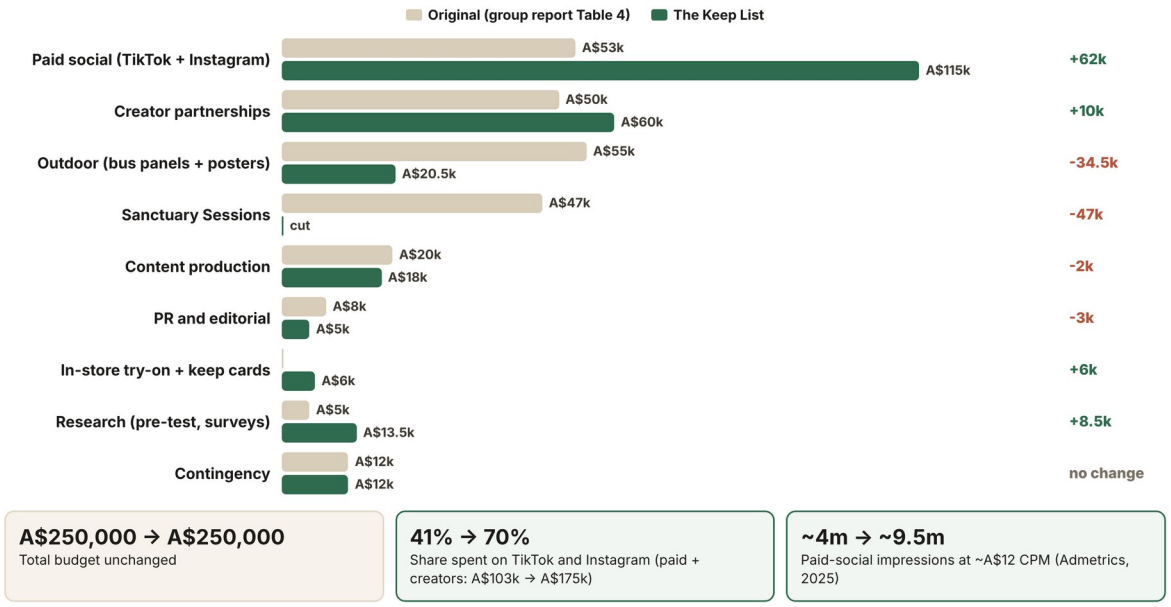


Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report's Figure 4.

Figure 4 shows the budget, which stays at A$250,000. Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000) are cut because their proof reached hundreds, and outdoor falls from A$55,000 to A$20,500 for Burst 1 panels on store routes. TikTok and Instagram rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, 70% of the budget. At about A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 of paid social buys roughly 9.5 million impressions, more than double the original four million. Concentration follows the Ben & Jerry's example (Snap Inc., 2025).

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000

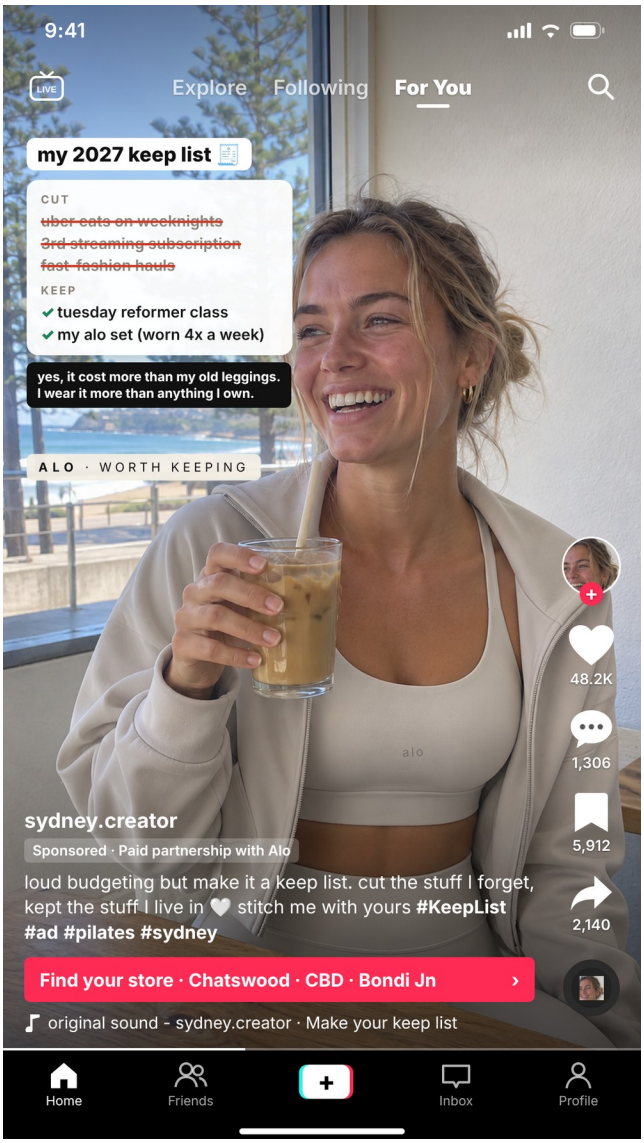


Note. Original figures from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels: 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators: about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

“The Keep List” TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. AI-generated photograph composed into a TikTok frame; the person is not real, and the handle and engagement figures are illustrative. AI prompts used. (1) Photograph, generated with [name the image tool you used]: “Photorealistic vertical 9:16 smartphone photo that looks like a still from an iPhone TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits at a small timber table by the window of a casual café in Bondi, Sydney, around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo Yoga–style set: a sleek, smooth sculpting sports bra and high-waisted leggings with a subtle sheen, in a soft neutral ‘bone’ colour, with an oversized cropped zip jacket in the same colour open over it. Clean, minimal, premium design. Do not render any text or logos on the clothing. Natural, unretouched skin, minimal makeup, hair in a slightly messy low bun, small gold hoop earrings. She is laughing naturally while holding an iced oat latte and looking just off camera. Soft morning sunlight comes through the window, with the ocean and Norfolk pines faintly visible and out of focus behind her. Handheld phone-camera look: slight grain, true-to-life colour, shallow depth of

field. Composition: she sits in the right half of the frame, shown from the waist up, with her face about 45% of the way down the image. Keep the upper-left third and the bottom quarter visually quiet so text overlays can sit there. No text, logos, watermarks or other people in focus." (2) TikTok frame, composed with Claude (Anthropic): "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You in-feed Spark Ad frame (1080 × 1920 px) with the status bar, LIVE/Explore/Following/For You tabs, right-hand rail (creator avatar with follow button, likes, comments, saves, shares, sound disc), 'Sponsored · Paid partnership with Alo' under the handle, the caption with #KeepList and #ad, a red call-to-action button 'Find your store · Chatswood · CBD · Bondi Jn' and the sound line. Add native TikTok text overlays in the empty window area: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list (CUT: uber eats on weeknights; 3rd streaming subscription; fast-fashion hauls, struck through; KEEP: tuesday reformer class; my alo set (worn 4x a week)), the aside 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.' and an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker. Add a small, correctly spelled 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep every overlay clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 is the opening frame of a 15-second TikTok in-feed Spark Ad, a creator's post boosted as paid media in the For You feed.

Message. The list is the argument: three things cut, two kept, then the admission "yes, it cost more than my old leggings". The sign-off "Alo. Worth keeping." attaches the justification to the brand. It persuades because it argues value in the audience's terms, not the brand's.

Imagery. A woman in her mid-twenties laughs over an iced latte in a beachside Sydney café after class, wearing the matching set. Natural light, unretouched skin and a handheld look suit Gen Z's preference for authenticity (Francis & Hoefel, 2018), making the endorsement believable, while the local setting supports O2.

Design. Native TikTok text sits in empty window space, so the post reads as creator content, while Alo's neutral palette, wordmark and sticker preserve brand linkage. "Sponsored · Paid partnership" sits under the handle and #ad in the caption, because advertising must be clearly distinguishable (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021) and native formats can obscure that content is advertising (Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action and engagement. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction (O3, O4), while the caption invites viewers to Stitch their own list, turning viewers into sources.

AI limitations. The AI-generated photograph is believable but too polished for phone footage, and audiences tend to see artificial personas as uncanny and "authentically fake" (Lou et al., 2023). The tool also cannot reproduce Alo's garments or logo, so the wordmark was added afterwards. In execution, a real creator wears real Alo, and each list reflects her genuine trade-offs, because scripted claims presented as personal experience would be misleading (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Measurement

An A/B pre-test compares the two-sided list with a one-sided version on brand attribution and “worth paying more for” (Belch & Belch, 2021). Platform holdouts now cover 46% of spend rather than 21% (Gordon et al., 2019; Appendix D).

2.8 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

Compared with the original, The Keep List argues price to the whole segment, gives an ownable proposition and doubles paid reach within the same budget. It has three limitations. First, financial hardship is a recognised source of consumer vulnerability (Australian Competition and Consumer Commission [ACCC], 2021), and manipulation undermines normal decision-making (Sher, 2011), so lists celebrate what people cut and never present the set as a necessity. Second, loud budgeting peaked in 2024, so the campaign uses “Keep List”, not the trend’s name. Third, cutting sessions and walks loses hands-on proof and editorial coverage, which in-store try-ons only partly replace. Overall, I expect a stronger O1 result, a similar O3 result and an O4 result that still depends on the store experience.

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Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

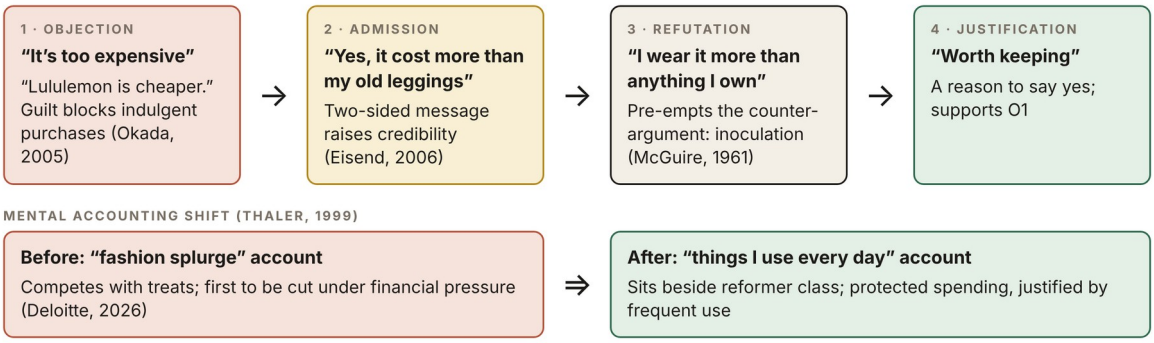
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value (Sichtmann et al., 2019); target sits near the ~5-point survey limit	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never addresses price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. Agency evaluation supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

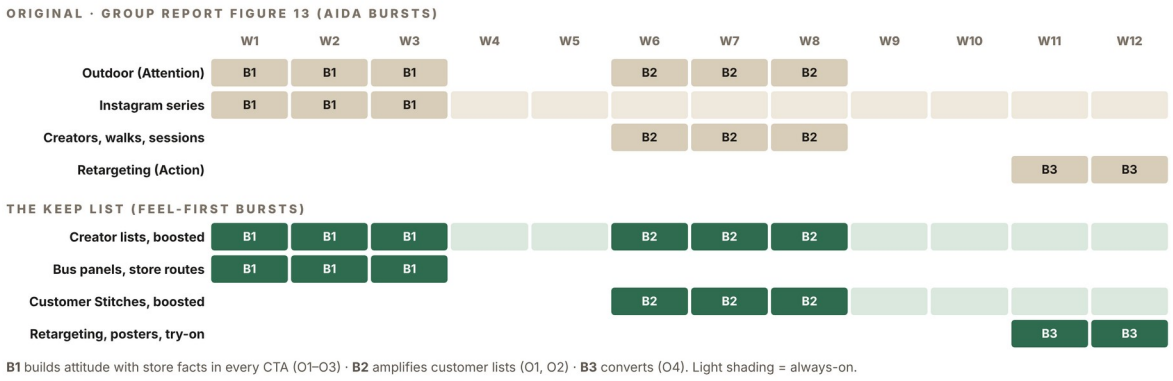


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After



Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13; pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).